

ion. The phone fits quite comfortably in the palm of your hand, and at a thickness of just 11.6mm, is one of the slimmest phones around. So we think it might be possible to use it with your thumb while holding it in your hand. We'll have to wait and see if single handed operation on the iPhone is possible or not.

Google Maps

Yes, you can indeed search for all the Starbucks in San Francisco and even get directions to them along with its phone number and address. However, this level of detail is not offered in India by Google Maps. The best you can do in India is search for a city and view the map and satellite imagery for it. Even the maximum zoom level in the satellite imagery is pretty dismal. The only landmark it recognised of the tens of options we tried was the Taj Mahal. It had no idea where the Red Fort was in New Delhi, or the Qutab Minar, IIT Kharagpur, the Lotus Temple, Jantar Mantar, pretty much anything in India apart from the cities and the Taj Mahal. This means that all that fancy stuff you can do with Google Maps on the iPhone is limited to the United States. We can only hope that Google gets its act together and provides extensive Google Maps coverage in India.

The Camera

A two megapixel camera! On Apple's latest phone! That's like so last century! OK, so maybe the reaction of potential customers won't be that dramatic, but it is pretty disappointing that a phone that Apple will launch in June 2007 and will cost a lot should only have a 2MP camera onboard. A year or two earlier, it might have been acceptable, but we have 3.2 and 5 megapixel phones from other companies in the market today. If this were a product from some other company, it might still have been ignored without much grief—but this is Apple we are talking about, a company supposed to be leading from the front.

Limited memory

At first glance, a total memory of 8 GB seems pretty sufficient for a phone. But let us not overlook the fact that this is not just a phone, it is a full-fledged portable media player, one that has a 3.5-